

Inkjet printers are not a viable option for a work place since most office documents printed are full of text with a few odd colour prints. In such cases, Laser-based MFDs that generate a large number of printouts at a low running cost, come in handy. We tested three Laser MFDs from different price brackets, aimed at three different types of audiences. Read on to find out more about the Laser trio.

Samsung SCX 4016

Fast to print, but slow to scan

The 4016 offers laser printing, digital copying and colour scanning, but doesn't integrate faxing. The operation console is intuitive, with button functions clearly marked. The little LCD panel displays sufficient information, but it could have been a little larger. It is built for economy with such features as Toner Save. Paper handling is via a 250-sheet capacity paper cassette. There's also a single-sheet feeding mechanism on the front side.

The printer unit is the ML-1710, which is the fastest laser printer that we've tested so far. The scanner unit performed rather badly—its IT8 cards tonal deviation test was the worst of any in this entire comparison. Results were similarly poor in the dark region of the IT8 card—but with acceptable resolution. Copies on the 4016 were crisp and clear, and the time it took for a copy was average (10 seconds).

At Rs 36,000, the SCX 4016 is a good deal if you want a laser MFD with fast printing and decent printouts. The unit as a whole should be up to the task in a typical office.



Price: Rs 36,000
Pros: Fast print speed
Cons: No faxing capability

Samsung SCX 4016		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Samsung SCX 4216F

Print 'em cheap

The 4216F has good fax features such as support for resolutions up to 300 x 300, 4 MB of memory—enough for storing 320 pages, fax forwarding, and more.

The 4216F comes with a hefty 8 MB of buffer memory that gives it the extra edge while bulk printing. It connects to a PC via both, the USB and parallel interface. The scanner unit supports a native optical resolution of 600 x 600 and an enhanced resolution of 4800 x 4800 dpi.



The printer unit is the fastest we've encountered, and the prints are crisp and crystal clear. At scanning, the SCX 4216F is slower than the 4016. In the IT8 card tonal deviation test, the scanner unit on the 4216F performed no better than did that on the 4016. And in the resolution test, the unit was just mediocre, not detecting the finer lines. Copying quality was excellent, and copying speed was typical.

The cartridge for the 4216F is priced at Rs 3,300, and this means lower cost-per-page as compared to any Inkjet MFD.

Priced at Rs 45,000, the SCX 4216F offers good features at a competitive price and should be considered if you want to replace all your ageing peripherals with a single cost-effective solution.

Price: Rs 45,000
Pros: Feature-rich
Cons: Scanner unit not up to the mark

Samsung SCX 4216F		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Xerox WorkCentre Pro 412

The daddy of MFDs

The Xerox WorkCentre Pro 412 is a top-of-the-range MFD solution for corporate users, and dwarfs all the others, in features and performance alike.

The 412 looks like a full fledged copier—It's huge, and weighs 22 kg.

The feature list on the 412 is long and extensive—the paper loading cassette has a capacity of 650 pages. The printer unit supports a true resolution of 600 x 600. The scanner unit employs a CCD sensor, and supports a true resolution of 600 x 600. The 35-pages Automatic Document Feeder simplifies scanning. The fax features 4 MB of memory that can store 400 pages of faxes, and can acquire a maximum modem speed of 33.6 kbps. The 412 supports multiple copies of a single document, from 1 to 999.

Printing was fast, and the quality was excellent. Both text and image scanning were fast. In the IT8 card tonal deviation test, the 412 demonstrated excellent colour reproducing capability. But in the colour deviation test for the lighter regions of the spectrum, the 412 performed badly. Resolution was average.

The 412 showed its true mettle in the copying test: where all the other MFDs take a minimum of 20 seconds, the 412 completed the same job in just 12 seconds, and that, without any loss of quality.

The Xerox WorkCentre Pro 412 is priced at Rs 73,500 plus taxes. Although it's expensive, it makes up for it with features that'll meet the demands of most offices.

Price: Rs 73,500
Pros: Excellent performance and great features
Cons: Expensive

Xerox WorkCentre Pro		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	